

CADY H. NGO

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EDUCATION

B.A. in Mathematics and Economics (*with honors*), minor in Statistics

2025

Grinnell College

- Relevant Coursework: Abstract Algebra, Applied Game Theory, Applied Statistics, Biological Psychology, Data Science, Differential Equations, Design & Analysis of Experiments, Econometrics, Number Theory, Probability Theory, Real Analysis, Research Methods, Statistical Modeling

Visiting Honours Student

2024

University of Edinburgh

- Relevant Coursework: Computing & Numerics, Programming & Numerical Methods for Economics

RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

Chen Predoctoral Fellow in Social and Decision Neuroscience

2025–Present

Division of the Humanities and Social Sciences & Chen Institute for Neuroscience, Caltech

- PI: Colin Camerer
- Developing multi-agent LLM trading infrastructure to simulate human-like bubble behavior (via NLP extraction, LLM self-prompting, and reinforcement learning) toward AI substitution for human participants
- Administering fMRI tasks manipulating curiosity-risk tradeoffs via calibrated electrical stimulation to examine striatum-amygdala competition in human decision-making under uncertainty

Visiting Research Fellow

2024–2025

Division of the Humanities and Social Sciences, Caltech

- PI: Colin Camerer
- Conducted in-lab and virtual experiments via Caltech's SSEL and Prolific, collecting experimental stock market and biometric data (e.g., EDA, HR, BVP, skin temperature) using Empatica wearables
- Implemented machine learning (e.g., LASSO, RFs) and forecasting models to predict asset bubble formation
- Pioneered project using affect-based photo databases to induce exogenous insular cortex activation

Mentored Advanced Project in Computational Modeling of Music

2025

Department of Psychology & Department of Music, Grinnell College

- Self-developed an original interdisciplinary framework integrating game theory, statistical learning, and music cognition to model listener expectation and musical preference in Western classical music
- Designed and analyzed normal form, sequential, and signaling games to formalize strategic interactions between melody and bass under coordination and asymmetric information
- Grounded theoretical payoffs in entropy-based measures derived from Markov models and PCA summaries of pitch transition data from Beethoven piano sonatas

Research Fellow at Opportunity Insights

2023

Department of Economics, Harvard University

- PIs: Raj Chetty and Gregory Bruich
- Employed Stata to clean, sort, and analyze census data sets, investigating the correlation between highways and declining social mobility in major American cities
- Designed empirical models (i.e., DID, RD), conducted lit review, and produced paper with replication code

WORKING PAPERS

Ngo, C. H.[†], Henning, T.[†], Spoon, R. L.[†], Toma, F. M.[†], Han, J., Smith, A., & Camerer, C. F. Skin in the Game: Electrodermal Arousal, Expectations, and Bubbles in Experimental Asset Markets. *Under review.* [\[Paper\]](#) [\[Poster\]](#)

Ngo, C. H. Feeding Attendance: The Impact of California’s Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism. [[Paper](#)] [[Poster](#)] [[Slides](#)]

Zhang, B., Towner, E., **Ngo, C. H.**, & Mobbs, D. Neural Mechanisms of Curiosity in Risky Decision-Making: An fMRI Investigation. [[Github](#)]

SELECTED WORKS IN PROGRESS

Ngo, C. H., Manning, B. S., Avery, C. N., & Camerer, C. F. Persona Construction for Large Language Model Agents in Experimental Asset Markets. [[Paper](#)] [[Poster](#)] [[Slides](#)]

Ngo, C. H. & Camerer, C. F. Ultra-Processed Foods, Supernormalization, and Rational Inattention.

†: *equal contribution*

AWARDS & GRANTS

External

Midwest Economics Association’s Best Undergraduate Paper, Honorable Mention	2025
Thomas and Charlotte Taylor Scholarship (\$10,000)	2024–2025
San Gabriel Women’s Club Scholarship (\$4,000)	2021–2025
PREDOC.org Service Honorarium (\$500)	2024
National Institute of Statistical Sciences Ingram Olkin Forums Travel Grant (\$450)	2023
PREDOC.org Summer Research Award (\$2,000)	2023

Caltech

Tianqiao and Chrissy Chen Predoctoral Fellowship Grant (\$2,500)	2025
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Grinnell

Gilbert DeBartolo ’69 Memorial Prize in Economics (\$1,300)	2025
Dean’s Office Research Conference Travel Grant (\$1,920)	2025
Professional Development Grant (\$1,700)	2024–2025
Founder’s Scholarship (\$64,000)	2021–2025
Grinnell Choice Scholarship (\$40,000)	2021–2025
Graduate School Scholarship (\$700)	2024
Summer Research Grant (\$4,000)	2024
Externship Grant (\$960)	2023
Hill Distinguished Award for Outstanding Music Performance (\$750)	2023

CONFERENCE & WORKSHOP PRESENTATIONS

2026	Economic Science Association (ESA) North American Meeting in Charlottesville, VA (Oct 29-Nov 1) <i>Talk:</i> Persona-Prompted LLM Traders as a Design for Experimental Asset Markets
	Conference on Language Modeling (COLM): Workshop on Agent Behavior in San Francisco, CA (Oct 9) <i>Poster:</i> A Recipe for Creating Human-Like Bubbles in LLM-Populated Experimental Asset Markets
	Research and Behavioral Finance Conference (RBFC) at VU Amsterdam <i>Talk:</i> A Recipe for Creating Human-Like Bubbles in LLM-Populated Experimental Asset Markets

- Economic Science Association (ESA) World Meeting in Los Angeles, CA
Talk[‡]: A Recipe for Creating Human-Like Bubbles in LLM-Populated Experimental Asset Markets
- 2nd Workshop on AI Behavioral Science at Stanford
Talk[‡]: Persona Prompting of LLMs to Match Human Behavior in Experimental Asset Markets
- Behavioral and Experimental Economics Coffee Hour at Caltech
Talk[‡]: Psychobiological Correlates of Experimental Asset Bubbles
- Chen Institute Neuro Lunch Meeting at Caltech
Talk[‡]: Psychobiological Correlates of Experimental Asset Bubbles
- 2025 15th Annual Behavioral Science and Health Symposium at University of Pennsylvania
Talk: Ultra-Processed Foods, Supernormalization, and Rational Inattention
- PREDOC.org Research Conference at the World Bank in Washington, D.C.
Poster: The Impact of California’s Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism
- Midwest Economics Association 89th Annual Meeting in Kansas City, MO
Talk^{*}: The Impact of California’s Universal Meals Program on Public School Absenteeism
- 2024 Research in Behavioral Finance Conference (RBFC) at VU Amsterdam
Talk[‡]: The Psychobiological Predictability of Experimental Asset Bubbles
- Los Angeles Experiments (LAX) Workshop at Caltech
Poster: The Market’s Hidden Signals: Using Biometric Data to Predict Financial Bubbles
- SFP Summer Seminar Day at Caltech
Poster: The Market’s Hidden Signals: Using Biometric Data to Predict Financial Bubbles
- 2023 Undergraduate Research Conference at the Federal Reserve Board of Governors in Washington, D.C.
Poster: America’s Interstate System as an Agent of Dampening Social Mobility
- PREDOC.org Seminar Series
Talk: America’s Interstate System as an Agent of Dampening Social Mobility

‡: *presented by co-author* *: *special recognition or award*

TEACHING, SERVICE, REFEREEING

Teaching

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| TA for Colin Camerer, AI and Social Sciences (EC/PSY/SS 104), Caltech | Fall 2026 |
| Course Tutor, Research Methods (PSY 225), Grinnell College | Fall 2024, Spring 2025 |

Service

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| Summer Undergraduate Research Fellowship (SURF) Mentor, Caltech | 2026 |
| Board Member and Mentor, Diversity and Inclusion Club for Economics (DICE), Grinnell College | 2024–2025 |
| Elected Board Member, Student Educational Policy Committee for Economics, Grinnell College | 2022–2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Faculty hiring and tenure review committees • Panelist, Economics Research Workshop (2025); Economics Internship Workshop (2024) | |
| Advisory Board, PREDOC.org | 2023–2025 |
| <ul style="list-style-type: none"> • Panelist, 4th Annual PREDOC.org Research Conference at UChicago Booth (2026); PREDOC.org Summer School (2024) | |

Refereeing

- PNAS Nexus

CERTIFICATES & CERTIFICATIONS

Certificates

Math for AI, Division of Engineering and Applied Sciences, Caltech	2025
Using Big Data to Solve Economic and Social Problems, Opportunity Insights and PREDOC.org	2023

Certifications

[CITI Biomedical Research](#)
[CITI Hybrid Research](#)
[CITI Social & Behavioral Research](#)

OTHER EXPERIENCE

Workshops Attended

Theory-Driven Experiments, Center for Theoretical and Experimental Social Sciences, Caltech	2026
Statistical Challenges in the Analysis of Police Use of Force, NISS Ingram Olkin Forum S^3 Series	2023

Selective Doctoral Preview Programs

Doctoral Preview Day, Brown University	2025
Colorado Advantage Program, University of Colorado Boulder	2025
Explore Michigan Engineering Research & Graduate Education (EMERGE), University of Michigan	2025

Employment

Research Assistant, Department of Economics, East Los Angeles College	2019
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SKILLS

Programs

Python, R, Julia, Stata, L^AT_EX, SPSS

Experiment Software

Gorilla, oTree, Prolific, Qualtrics, Unity, WebGazer.js

Tools

Siemens Prisma 3 Tesla MRI, Empatica E4 & Embrace

MISC

Languages

English (native), Vietnamese (intermediate), Cantonese (elementary)

Citizenship

USA

Updated: September 25, 2026